



Aggie Reuse Store: WQ26 Donor Analysis

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Introduction:

The Aggie Reuse Store (ARS) is a student-run unit under ASUCD, dedicated to recycling, collecting, and reselling clothes for all Davis students and community members. Its impact on both the environment and users cannot be underestimated, with 1.5 million tons of waste diverted, 2,000+ students served, and 5,000+ items rehoused. In addition, the welcoming staff, wide selection of goods, and zero cost make it one of UC Davis's most important resources.

The beating heart of the organization is the donors. Their donations are what fill the store's shelves with goods for our patrons to shop from. Without their generosity, ARS would cease to exist. However, because donations are made without any documentation, it's difficult to understand the demographics and motivations behind their contributions. These details are crucial to understanding our donors and exploring potential trends between them. For these reasons, ARS's Data Team has decided to design the Donor Analysis Project, aimed at collecting and analyzing details about donors and comprehending what/why they donate.

The project would be split into a development, collection, and analysis phase. The data used for this project was collected by a survey and was completely anonymous. The survey ran from January 16th to March 20th, allowing data collection across 9 weeks; therefore only pertained to UC Davis's Winter Quarter.

Note: This analysis is not fully representative of all of our donors.

Development:

The project would begin in October 2025, with the ideation of questions, the survey platform, and research questions all being taken into account. After many revisions, by January 2026, the questionnaire was ready for deployment on Qualtrics (survey platform). The survey was accompanied by a Canva flyer (with a QR code), allowing our sales staff to administer the inquiry simply.

Whilst the survey was collecting responses, the team would embark on learning Tableau[1], the platform on which the visualizations were built. Learning the platform's full capabilities would assist in maximizing the use of our data and creating accurate visuals. Once the course was completed, development of Tableau storyboards began, such as importing toy data (samples) and trying different visualizations. Upon uploading the real dataset and finalizing the storyboard, the last step was to write an analysis.

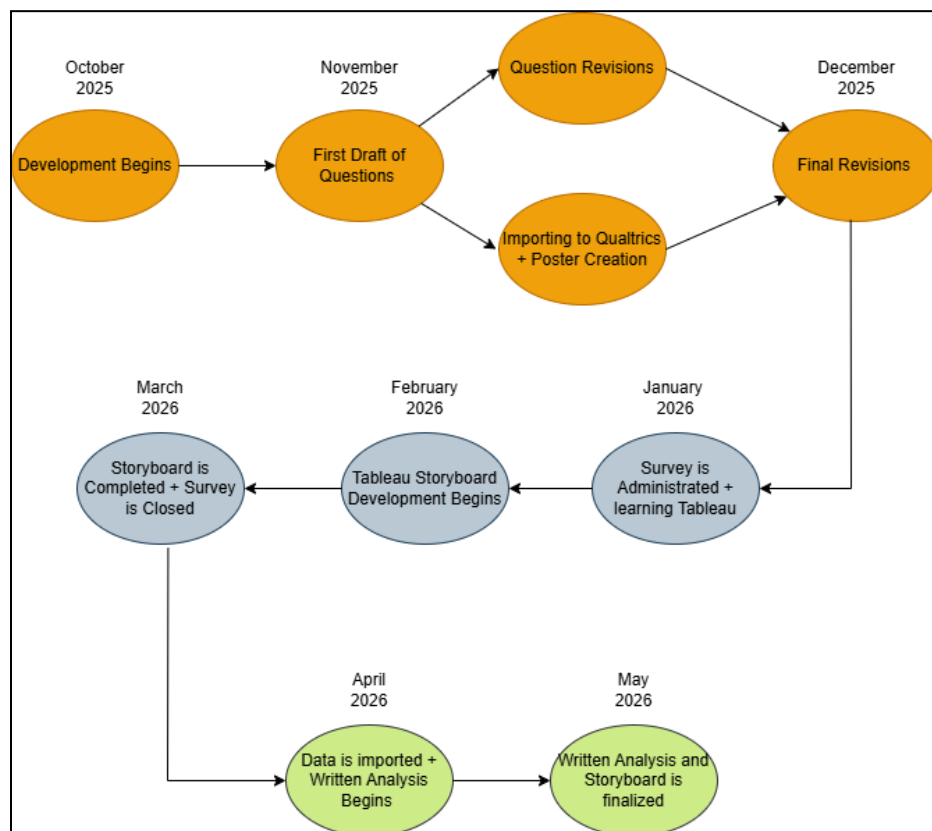


Figure 1: A flowchart of the project's development.

Data Processing:

On March 20th, ARS closed the survey for Winter Quarter 2026, thus beginning the data cleaning process. The data would be imported from Qualtrics into Google Sheets, where it was cleaned. This step includes:

- Deleting unnecessary information
- Removing uncompleted entries
- Renaming column names
- Adding a “Total Donation” column.

Deleting Unnecessary Information:

While initially observing the data, we were shocked to see the IP addresses, locations, and other information tracked. This was alarming as we intended the survey to be completely anonymous. Thankfully, the survey was only distributed through our storefront at the Memorial Union, so no addresses were actually tracked. We turned on anonymous mode after discovering the issue and immediately deleted all personal data collected prior.

After importing the CSV file into Google Sheets, it was evident that the data was full of needless details. Most unnecessary data was info generated by Qualtrics, relating to the logistics of the survey. Deleting these columns decluttered our database, resulting in faster search times for important information. Deleted columns included:

- Response Type (Binary, 1 = Completed, 0 = Incompleted)
- REcaptcha score
- Duration (in seconds)
- User Language
- Start/End Date

Removing Uncompleted Entries

Users who did not complete our survey provided little of importance, as key information would be absent. Most notably, their donation contents. Thus, we deleted all entries that did not complete >80% of our survey.

Renaming Columns

The database's columns were directly copied from the survey's questions, resulting in question-like names. As a result, each column's name was changed to reflect that of a proper dimension.

Adding a “Total Donation” column

Totaling all of our donations into one variable would be useful when conducting donation analysis. By summing all donations made by an individual, we'd achieve this new column.

Final Dataset

The finalized dataset included:

Theme	Description	Columns
Meta Data	Data not entered by the user.	Date and Time, completion.
Donation Contents	The number and category of items being donated.	Sweaters, Shoes, Accessories...
Item Condition	The quality and estimate of items with the quality	Item Condition
Donation Reasons	Why someone donated	Donation Reasons
General Demographics	Grouping donors by their identity.	Ethnicity, Race, Gender
Affiliation	How are they affiliated with ARS	Affiliation.
Student Demographics	Grouping students by features	Year, College
Saff Demographics	Grouping staff by features	Faculty Role
Shopping habits	Questions related to our storefront	Outreach methods, Visit Frequency, and Possibility of redonating.

Table 1: A breakdown of columns in our final dataset.

For further details, the dataset can be viewed [here](#) [2].

Dashboard Analysis

After cleaning the data, we could now begin drafting the dashboard ideas. Each would attempt to visualize info grouped by category. The full storyboard can also be viewed [here](#) [3]. The generated dashboards included:

- Dashboard for Donations
- Dashboard for Demographics (1)
- Dashboard for Demographics (2)
- Dashboard for Students
- Dashboard for Store Statistics

All dashboards included graphs detailing donations by category (clothing type, household goods, etc) and donations by time. These are the two most important measures of collected data, so it's appropriate to include both in each dashboard. The inclusion of both graphs also helps when applying filters, as donations per category and day can be analyzed through other metrics, such as college years and reasons for donations.

Donations by Category:

Most of the data in “Donations by Category” seems skewed toward “other items”. This is peculiar, given the large number of categories available; it seems unlikely that 198 of our donations could be unclassified. Upon further analysis, there were a few influential donations for this reason:

- 100 Craft Supplies
- 50 Hoodies
- 20 Clothes Hangers

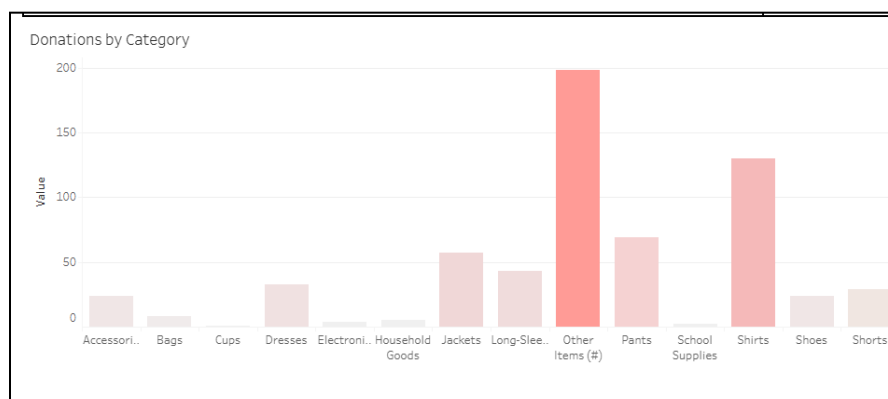


Figure 2: Donations by Category.

These donations, while having broader categories (School supplies, Sweaters/Jackets, Household goods), were incorrectly placed in the “other” category. Donors likely misinterpreted each broader category as a specific one, leading to the subsequent problem.

To prevent this from occurring again, clarification on each category will be provided before donors add their count. The figure below shows the updated dashboard, which shows the actual counts of each category after donations were correctly identified.

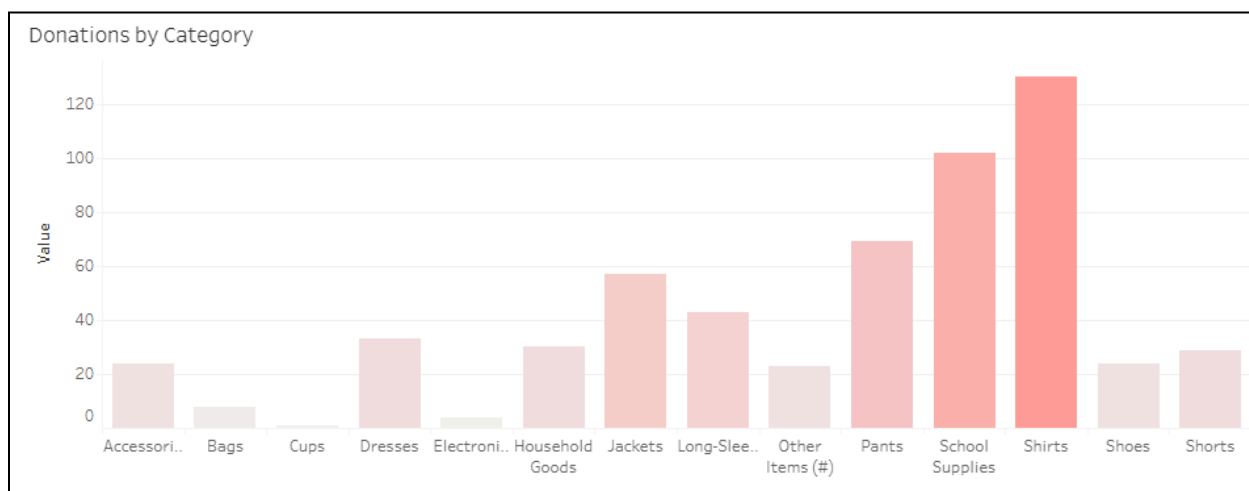


Figure 3, Updated Donations by Category.

Unsurprisingly, our most donated items are shirts, with more than 130 being donated this quarter. Additionally, art supplies became the second most popular category with 102 donations. Given how many T-shirts people have, and the location of the Aggie Reuse Store, it's unsurprising that these are our top 2 categories.

Donations by Date:

There is clearly one date that stands head and shoulders above the rest. January 29th had 231 donations (58% total), with 8 unique donors. It's not concrete; there are a few possible reasons:

- Feedback Survey being posted on Instagram (outreach survey, 1/29)
- 15% Yesterday, Vintage discount if you donate (IG post, 1/23)
- A group of friends/club donating together

While uncertain, the number of donations we receive can be unpredictable and potentially influenced by correlated events or chance (a mass of people deciding to donate). Regardless, the total of 398 logged donations is impressive, and helps skew our average to ~8 pieces of clothing being donated a day.

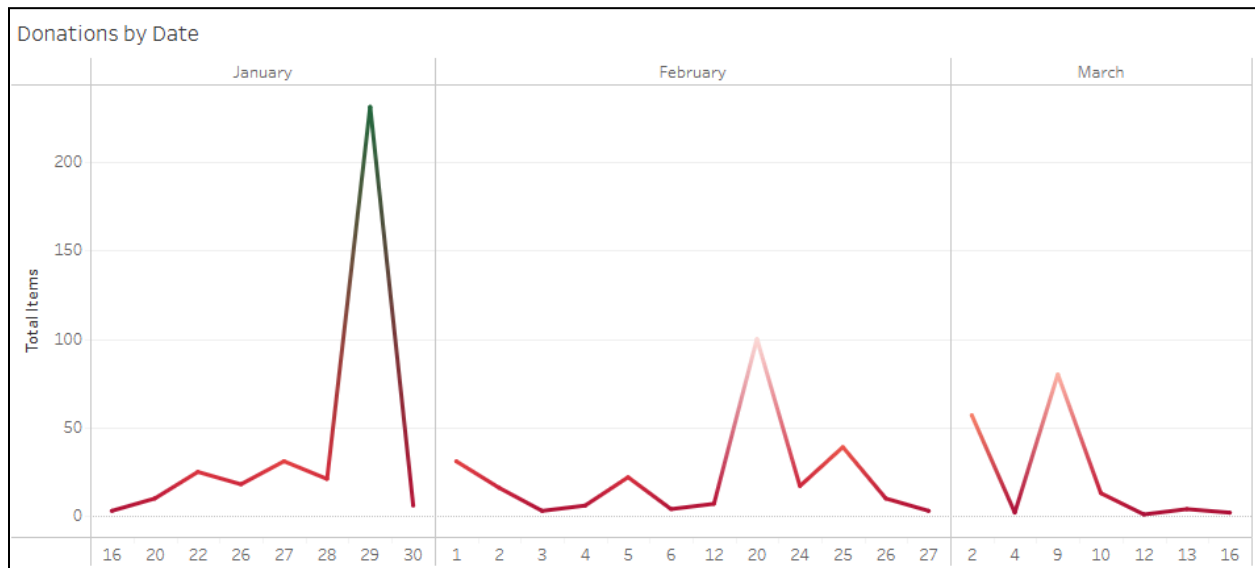


Figure 4, Donations by Date

Dashboard #1: Donations

The first dashboard measures metrics based on donations. This analysis uncovers reasons for donating and the quality of our clothing donations.

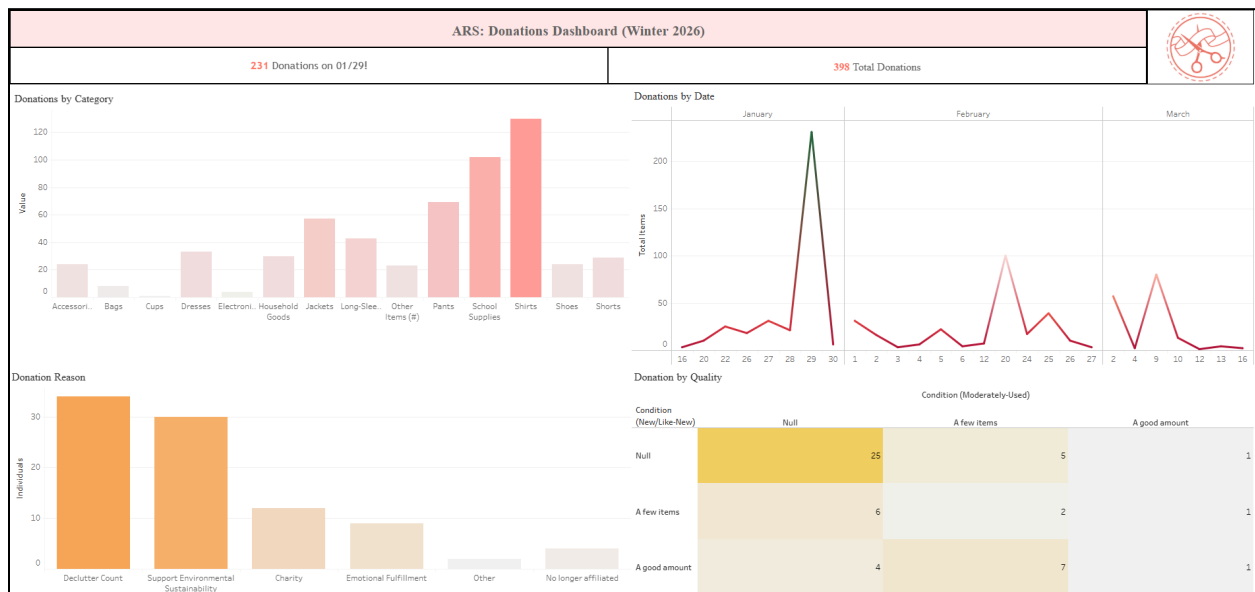


Figure 5, Screenshot of Donations Dashboard.

Donations by Reason:

Donors can select multiple reasons for donating, leading to overlapping percentages. The most common reason for donating was to declutter, with over 65% of donors citing it. Additionally, 58% donated to support environmental sustainability. These statistics present Aggie Reuse donors as both environmentally friendly and space-conscious.

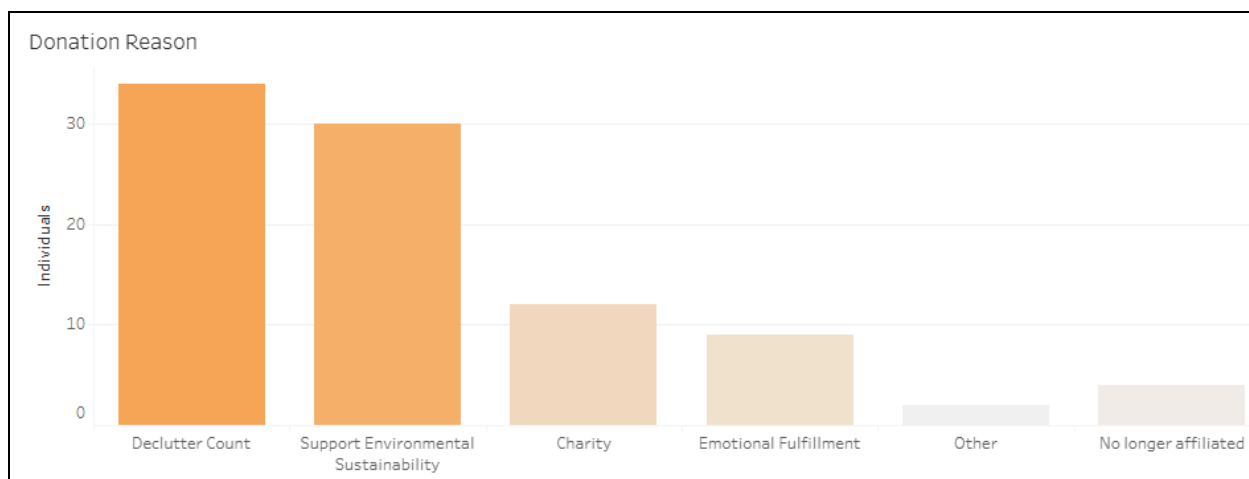


Figure 6, Donations by Reason

Donations by Quality:

This analysis is flawed because of the survey question it's based on.

There are three different clothing qualities (New, Like-new, moderately used), and three different clothing amounts (Null, A few items, A good amount). The idea of the question was for donors to select the condition and the amount for each category of clothing (i.e, A had a good amount of brand new clothing...). However, given that the question could be skipped by pressing null on each question, most of our donors chose this option. We will attempt to prevent this from occurring again through less/more clear options, and by preventing nulls.

Due to the high number of null values, it's likely our analysis will be incorrect. However, it seems most of our donors either had a mix assortment of new/moderately used items or donated like-new items.

Donation by Quality			
Condition (New/Like-New)	Condition (Moderately-Used)		
	Null	A few items	A good amount
Null	25	5	1
A few items	6	2	1
A good amount	4	7	1

Figure 7, Donations by Quality

Dashboard #2: Demographics(1)

The second dashboard details the ethnicity and race of donors. This dashboard was created to estimate the demographics and analyze potential trends among people who donate to Aggie Reuse.

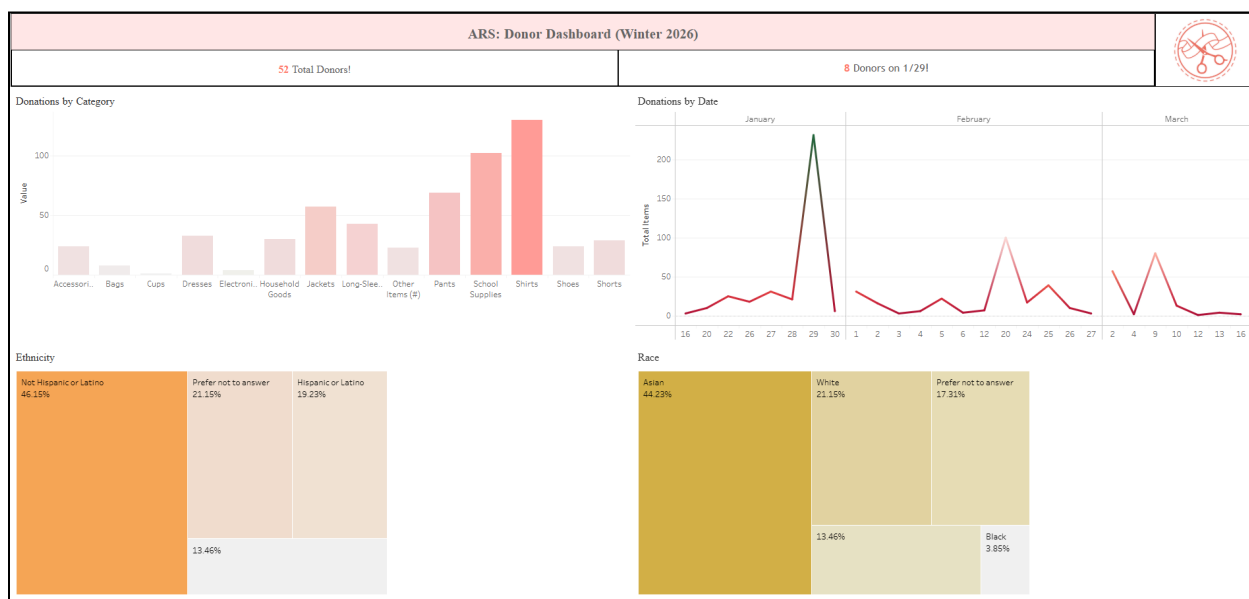


Figure 8, Screenshot of Demographics Dashboard (1).

Donors by Ethnicity/Race:

Given that both the donor ethnicity/race graphs address our donors' heritage, we will tackle them simultaneously. Both graphs paint a fairly cohesive picture: ARS donors are mostly of Asian (44%), Hispanic/Latino (19%), and White(21%) descent. This is fairly unsurprising if a little skewed (towards Asians), as the ethnic diversity of UC Davis roughly aligns with our donor demographics.

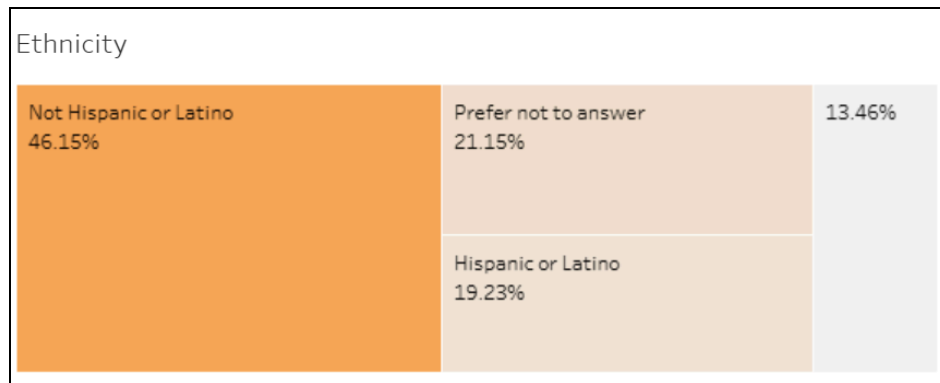


Figure 9, Donors by Ethnicity

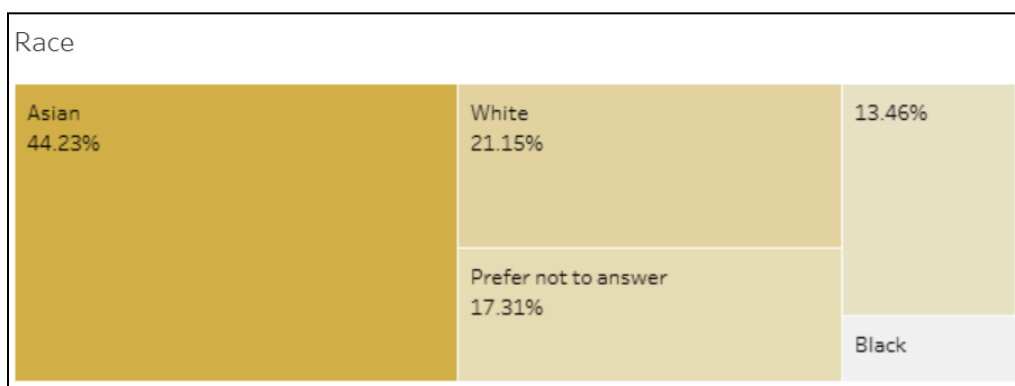


Figure 10, Donors by Race

Note: Students were unable to select multiple races due to survey design*

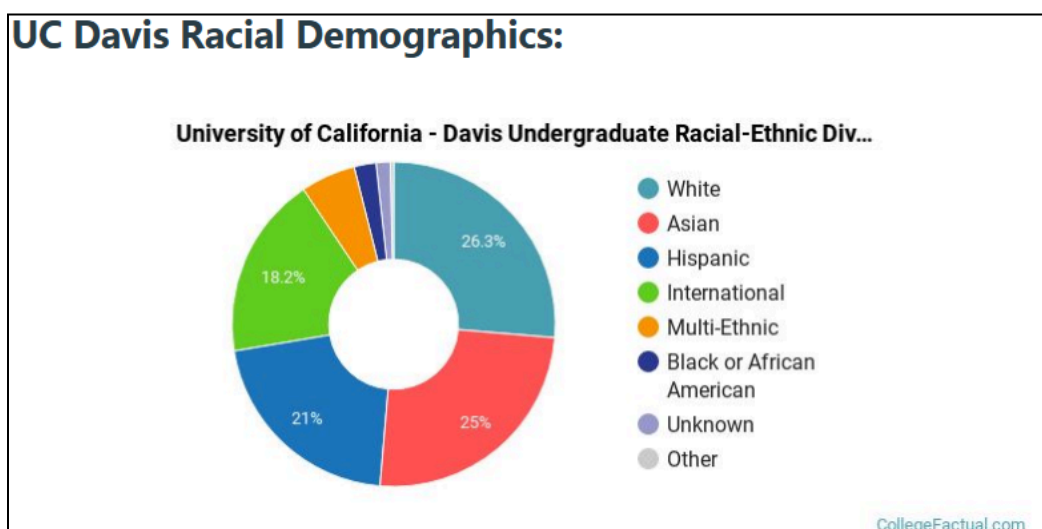


Figure 11, Racial-Ethnic Diversity of UC Davis [4]

Dashboard #3: Demographics(2)

The second demographic dashboard explores the gender and roles of donors. Similar to the previous dashboard, the following was created to observe if there are any underlying trends in either gender or the types of donors we receive.



Figure 12, Screenshot of Demographics Dashboard (2).

Donors by Gender:

Overwhelmingly, Females made up roughly 79% of our demographic. With such a large skew, it begs the question: why? With some research, the following conclusions were discovered:

- Females shop secondhand far more often (65%/35%) [5]
- A Heavier emphasis on Fashion(larger market, more clothing) [6]
- Many find it a hobby [7]

The following reasons help understand why donors were so staggeringly female.

Additionally, the following analysis could also apply to our customers, as there's likely a correlation between our users and donors.

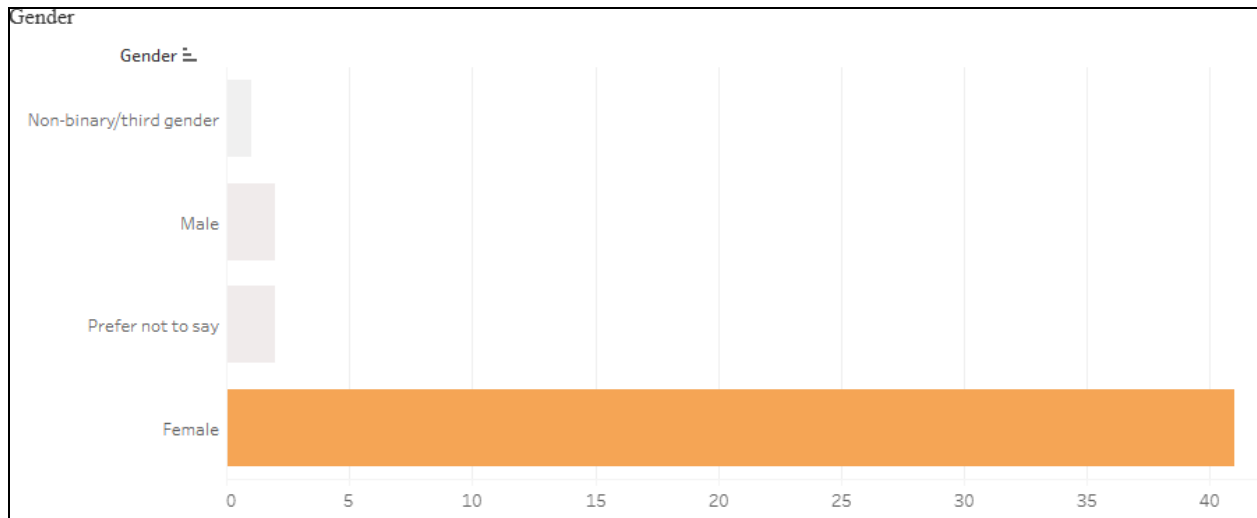


Figure 13, Count of donors for gender.

Donors by Roles:

Uniquely, Aggie Reuse not only opens its services to UC Davis affiliates, but also to the Davis general public. This allows community members to both donate and shop at the storefront, leading to occasional visits. Although the graph counts the number of donors for each category, the total donations for community members and students are 256 and 398, respectively. This implies that community members tend to donate more clothing, while UC Davis students donate more frequently.

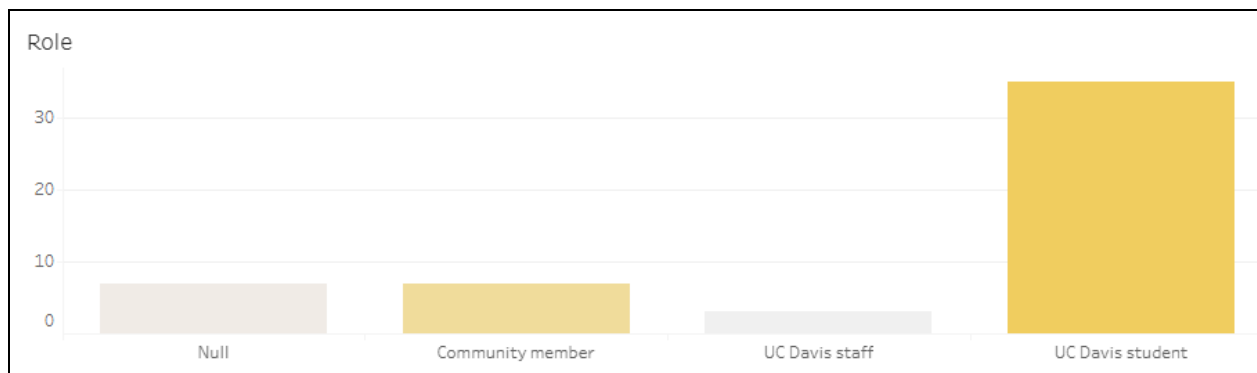


Figure 14, Count of donors for each category.

Dashboard #4: Students

Aggie Reuse is grateful for the 35 students who donated to the organization this quarter, stocking our shelves with 398 items. This dashboard is dedicated to our student

providers, examining relationships between college and years. The following aims to observe which student attributes have the largest impact on our storefront's shelves.



Figure 15, Screenshot of Student Dashboard.

Donors by Year:

Shockingly, the most donations came from freshmen. This is particularly interesting, as we believed seniors would have the most to donate. As a result of fourth years moving out (post-graduation), it was rational to believe many would donate to lessen their luggage.

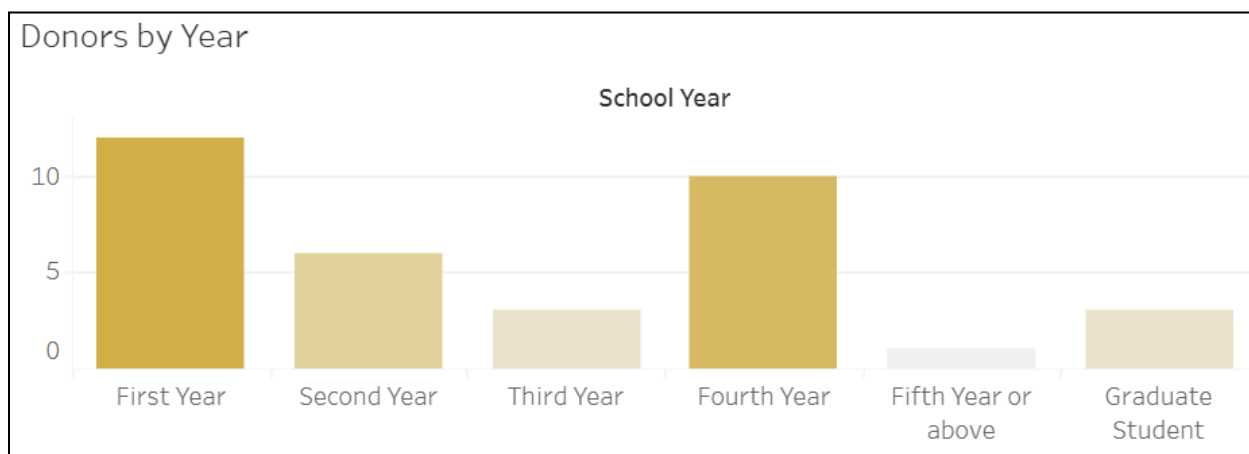


Figure 16, Distribution of Donors by Year.

However, upon further thought, we were able to come up with a few potential reasons:

- Freshmen overpack upon moving in

- Limited dorm space
- Moving out of dorms

Similar to seniors, freshmen have a wealth of reasons to donate clothing. If anything, they may have more reasons than seniors, given the restricted living space. The dorm rooms in Davis are fairly limited, offering little space for their belongings. This leads to potential overstock, resulting in some donating items to the Aggie Reuse.



Figure 17: A photo of a 3-bedroom UC Davis dorm.

Donors by College:

Unsurprisingly, our donors primarily consisted of students from Agricultural/ Environmental Science and Letters & Science. These results are as predicted because:

- Environmental science students resonate with ARS (ideals)
 - Also a large college
- Letters & Science is the most popular college.

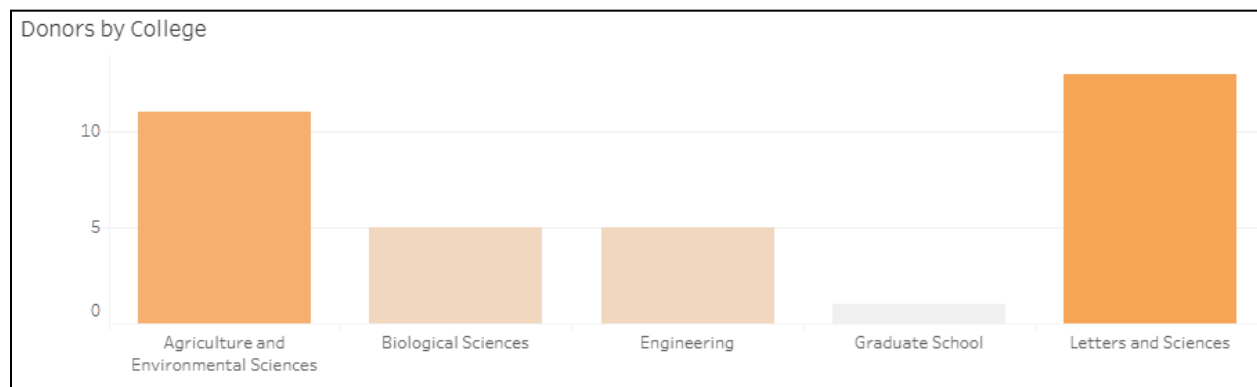


Figure 18, Donors by College.

Dashboard #5: Storefront

The fifth and final dashboard examines statistics related to Aggie Reuse's storefront. These results help examine our donors' trends in relation to the organization, exploring the most popular methods of outreach and the visit frequency of our donors.

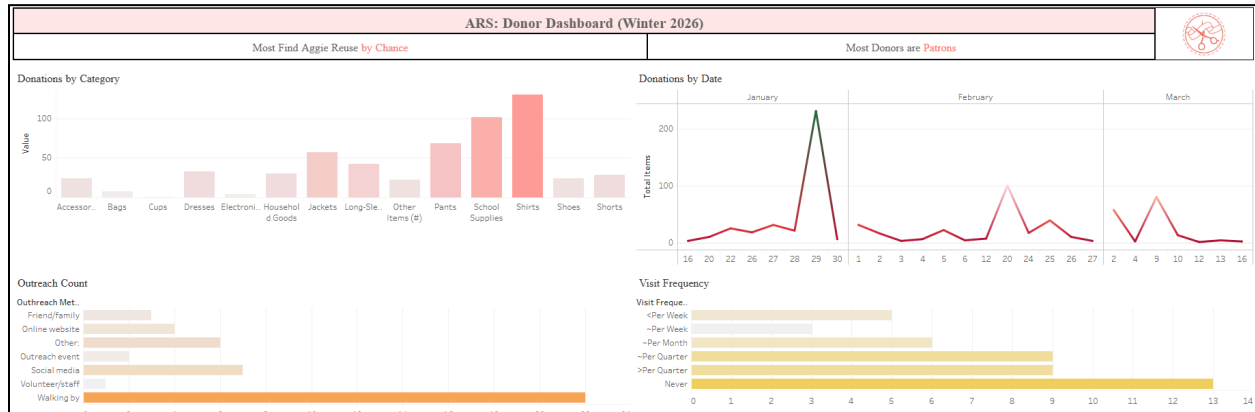


Figure 19, Screenshot of Store Dashboard.

Why so Many NULLs?

The overabundance of NULL values in both dashboards is due to the question placement in the survey. These were the final questions. The entries were kept because they contained valuable data about their donations, and deleting them would be costly (losing valuable data). Therefore, the following entries were kept.

While the null values provided important details on the rest of our categories, it adds little to no value here on this graph. Therefore, we will hide the null values for visual simplicity.

Outreach Method:

Aggie Reuse attempts to reach a larger audience through numerous methods, most notably tabling and social media posts. Both methods take time to create and work, with staff spending hours for either event to occur. Unfortunately, data shows that a majority of donors do not find the storefront through outreach events, but rather by simply walking by.

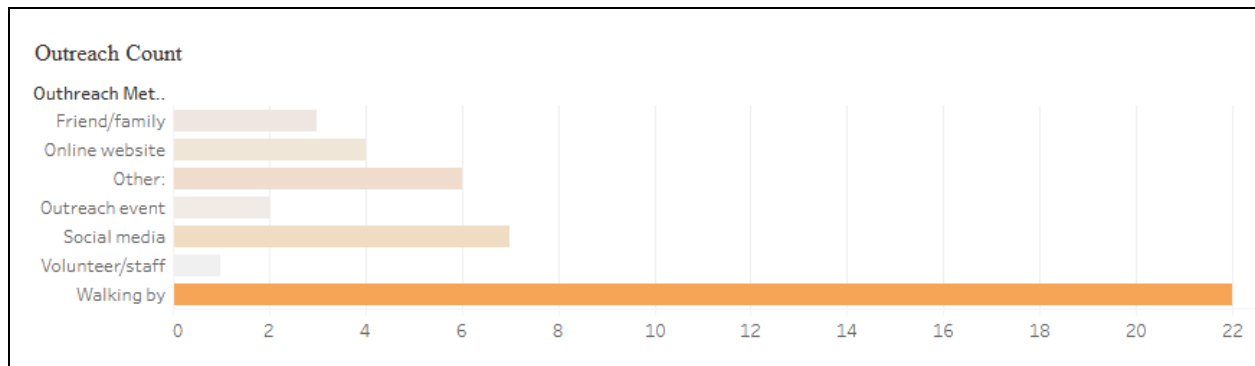


Figure 20, Donors by Outreach Method.

Because the Memorial Union (where ARS is located) is such a popular hub for both students and community members, it becomes clearer that one of ARS's biggest assets is its location and accessibility.

However, the lack of engagement from our donors and Social Media/Tabling is slightly disappointing yet understandable, as those events often draw in customers more than donors. In the future, more events focused on donations using incentives (i.e., Yesterday Vintage Event) could help ARS reach a wider donor demographic.

Visit Frequency:

Finally, the last graph details how often donors use the store, excluding the day of donation. The following trends display that our audience is a mix of both individuals who use and rarely use our resource.

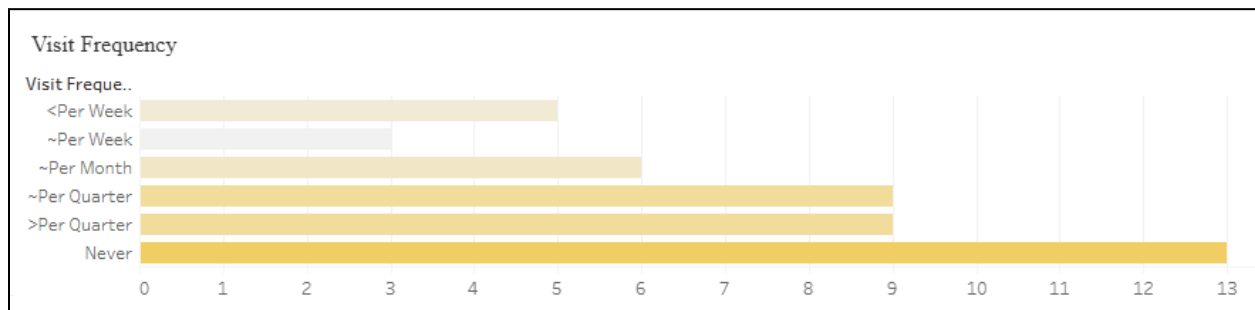


Figure 21, Donors by Visit Frequency.

Despite the most popular choice being “I have never visited”, it does not tell the full story of a majority of our donors. A large majority of donors are individuals who actively use our resource:

- 31% use our resource $\leq$ Month
- 40% Visited before donating at least once
- 29% Visited only to donate

The following distributions help describe that although a majority of donations are made by active customers, some people use ARS purely to donate and nothing more.

Conclusion:

Throughout Aggie Reuse's Winter Quarter, ASUCD's Aggie Reuse Store recorded 50+ donors, with 398 items being donated. The most donated day was January 29th, likely due to ARS's collaboration with Yesterday Vintage. Additionally, the biggest motivation for donating was decluttering and supporting environmental sustainability, indicating our audience is eco-friendly yet space-efficient.

79% of our donor base is female, which, given their shopping preferences (buying secondhand), hobbies, and emphasis on fashion, is understandable. There are 5x as many student donors as community members, making them the most popular role. However, community members have proven to be valuable donors, on average providing 3x more items than students.

Expanding on the student population, students in colleges of Agriculture/Environmental Sciences (32%) and Letters & Sciences (37%) tend to donate the most. This is likely because of the size of both colleges and the emotional connection AE Science students have to our organization. Both first and fourth-year students tend to donate more than any other year. This is likely due to both groups' upcoming moving dates (out of dorms/Davis), alongside the cramped living conditions of freshmen.

Lastly, 42% of our donors discover Aggie Reuse by chance. This is likely due to the store being inside the Memorial Union, a popular hub among students and adults alike. 71% of our donors have at least visited our organization once before donating, meaning donors are mostly comprised of previous customers.

Sources:

[1]Free, “Free Tableau Course with Certificate (2026) - Great Learning,” *Great Learning*, 2026.

<https://www.mygreatlearning.com/academy/learn-for-free/courses/tableau-for-beginners> (accessed Apr. 15, 2026).

[2]W. Donor, “Copy of Aggie Reuse: WQ26 Donor Analysis,” *Google Docs*, 2020.

https://docs.google.com/spreadsheets/d/1CWolEFyj2_2mFW7wrdbpToI2MFrnZgK6fUrG1GtOvr0/edit?usp=sharing (accessed May 17, 2026).

[3] *Tableau.com*, 2026.

<https://public.tableau.com/app/profile/alexander.cai5044/viz/ARSWorkbookFinal/ARS2025DonorStoryboard?publish=yes> (accessed May 17, 2026).

[4]“University of California - Davis Diversity: Racial Demographics & Other Stats,” *www.collegefactual.com*.

<https://www.collegefactual.com/colleges/university-of-california-davis/student-life/diversity/>

[5]J. Server, “Secondhand Clothes Shopping Is a Thrill for Some, a Necessity for Others,” *CivicScience*, Mar. 03, 2021.

<https://civicscience.com/secondhand-clothes-shopping-is-a-thrill-for-some-a-necessity-for-others/>

[6]T. S. Pages, “Why Women Have So Many Clothes - Sociological Images.”

<https://thesocietypages.org/socimages/2013/12/31/60871/>

[7]E. Huber, “For Gen Z, Thrifting Isn’t Just A Way To Shop, It’s A Lifestyle,”

www.refinery29.com, Oct. 29, 2020.

<https://www.refinery29.com/en-us/2020/10/10014753/thrifting-gen-z-thrift-shopping-trend>